

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K Q 10 9 6 2

♣ 10 8 6 2

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 9 7 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ Q J 3



♠ 9 6 4 2

♥ 5

♦ J 5 3

♣ A K 9 7 4

♠ K Q J 10 7 5

♥ A J 8 6 3

♦ A

♣ 5

Since there has not been a clear agreement on the trump suit you can assume it is ♥s, the last bid suit.

So you have two Key-Cards (♠A and ♥K, along with the ♥Q). You therefore bid 5♠ and partner bids 6♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

5♠

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A Q J 3

♦ Q 6

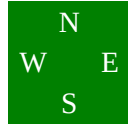
♣ K Q J

♠ 6 4

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10 7 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3



♠ A 10 9 7 3 2

♥ K 9 5

♦ 8 5

♣ A 7

♠ 8

♥ 10 7 4

♦ A K J 9

♣ 9 8 6 5 2

West

1 ♣

4 ♠

5 ♥

All Pass

5 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ K

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

5 ♣

5 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

Partner's jump to 4♠ indicates he is prepared to play at game even if you have as few as 6 points. So he must have 20 points or so. With your 14 that puts you in slam range.

Despite your conviction that this hand is going to slam you should **NOT** ask for Key-Cards holding a worthless doubleton. Instead, you make a slam try by bidding your cheapest control, 5♣. Partner says 5♥. What is your next bid?

You can only say 5♠. Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he held the Ace since controls are bid up-the-line. His failure to show it means he doesn't have it. Since you might be off the first two ♦ tricks you stop at 5♠.

Yes, partner should probably have opened 2NT. Sometimes partners don't make the bids you think they oughta.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 10 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 4
♣ J 9 6 5

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ A 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A 8 2



♠ A 4

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 9 6 2

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ 5

♣ K Q 3

You have 3 Key-Cards so you bid 5♦. Partner bids
6♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

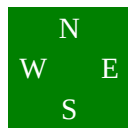
♠ A J 9 7 2
 ♥ K Q 5
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K 6

♠ 10 6

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 10 9 8 7 4

♣ 7 5 4



♠ K Q 8 4
 ♥ A J 6
 ♦ J 3
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 9 8 2

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ 10 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♠	Pass
6 ♠			
All Pass			
6 ♠ by West			
Lead: ♣4			

Your partnership plays Jacoby 2NT convention, so partner's 2NT shows a game-forcing raise in ♠s. Your 3NT bid indicates a 5-card suit and "extra values". Partner's 4♥ is a control-bid showing the ♥A.

What you need to know now about partner's hand is Key-Cards so you bid 4NT. He answers 5♠. What is your bid?

Partner's response says 2 Key-Cards and the ♠Q. So you are missing either the trump King or the ♦A. So you shouldn't bid 7, but you will almost surely make 6. You bid 6♠.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6



♠ 8 6 2

♥ K J 8 5 3 2

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			
6♦ by North			
Lead: ♣8			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

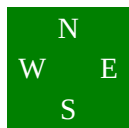
♠ A 6 5 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ K J 3
♣ 8 2

♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3



♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ —

♣ A K Q 7

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♠ 7			

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠ A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠ A or the practically useless ♦ A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠ A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

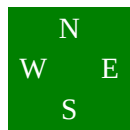
♠ 10 3
 ♥ Q 9 2
 ♦ K Q 8 7 5
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ —

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

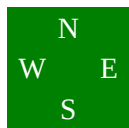
♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 10 7 6
 ♦ A Q J
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ 3 2

♥ J 3 2

♦ 8 7 6 4 3

♣ 8 4 3



♠ A 10 8
 ♥ K 9 8 4
 ♦ K 9
 ♣ K 10 6 5

♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♥			
All Pass			
5♥ by West			
Lead: ♠3			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 9

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 8 6 4

♥ 6 2

♦ 10 8 3

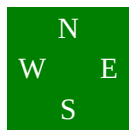
♣ J 5 2

♠ 7

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ 9 8 3



♠ 5 3 2

♥ 4 3

♦ J 9 6 2

♣ A 7 6 4

♠ A K Q J

♥ A J 10 7

♦ A 5

♣ K Q 10

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♣

Pass

5♣

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣A

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 10
 ♥ A K 9 8 4
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ K Q 6

♠ 9 8 2

♥ Q 10 3

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 7 5 4



♠ A Q J 7 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 4 3

♣ 8 2

♠ 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ A 10 9 3

*West**North**East**South*

		1 ♠	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♠	Pass
6 ♠			

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ J

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.

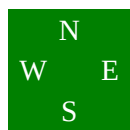
Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 6
♦ 10 9 6 5
♣ A 9 8 6 3 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ A Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 8
♣ 7



♠ 10 9 8
♥ 7 2
♦ 3 2
♣ K Q J 10 5 4

♠ 7 6 4 2
♥ K J 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ —

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 10 9 7
 ♥ K J 10
 ♦ Q J 10 3
 ♣ K J

♠ Q J 8

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A 9 7

♣ 8 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 6 5 2

♥ A Q 7 4

♦ K 8 6

♣ A Q

♠ 4 3

♥ 9 8 6

♦ 5 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 4 3

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♦	Pass
5♠			
All Pass			
5♠ by West			
Lead: ♣5			

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.

Board 13

West Deals

Both Vul

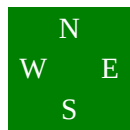
♠ 10 6 2
♥ Q 2
♦ 10 5 3 2
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5



♠ 8 5 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 6

♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ 10 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠4

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 14

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ A K 9 8 6 5
 ♦ K
 ♣ A 3 2

♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 7

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 3

♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5

♣ K

♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ 10 4 2

♦ 2

♣ J 10 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♣	Pass	5NT	Pass
6 ♦	Pass	7NT	

All Pass

7NT by East

Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ A 6 5 3 2
 ♣ 9 4

♠ —

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J 10 8 3



♠ A J 9 5 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8

♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ 10

♣ A K Q 6

West

North

East

South

Pass 3♠ Pass 1♥

Pass 6♥ Pass 4NT

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

Board 16

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

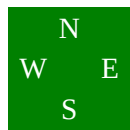
♣ A 5

♠ 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A Q J 10 4

♣ Q 9 8



♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ —

♣ K J 10 2

♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

6 ♦

Pass

7 ♠

All Pass

7 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ 3

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

Board 17

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ J 9 5 3

♦ 5 2

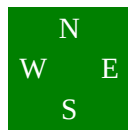
♣ 4 3 2

♠ K 8 7

♥ A 10 6

♦ Q 9 7 4

♣ J 10 8



♠ 10 4 3

♥ K Q 8 7 2

♦ J

♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ A Q 5

♥ 4

♦ A K 10 8 6 3

♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	5♠	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by North

Lead: ♥K

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 18

South Deals

N-S Vul

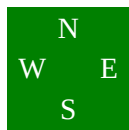
♠ Q 8
 ♥ A J 9 7
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ A K Q 6

♠ A K J 6 5 2

♥ 5

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 7 5



♠ —

♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 7 4 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 9 6 2

♣ 9 4 3

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Lead: ♦ 10

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.

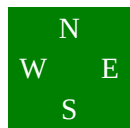
Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ Q 4 3
 ♦ Q J 7 5 2
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ K 10 7 2
 ♥ A K 8 6 5
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ 6 4



♠ 9
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ 10 9 7 5 2

♠ A Q J 8 5 4 3
 ♥ 7
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♦	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			

Your 2♥ response shows 8+ points, with at least 5♥s.

Your hand is looking better and better. You already gave a positive response so you know you are forced to game. It is better to keep the bidding low to allow more investigating room so you bid 3♠. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

With ♠s agreed as trumps you have two Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♥A. With no trump Queen you respond 5♥. Partner now says 5NT. What do you reply?

Partner is asking for Kings and you have just 1, the ♥K. Remember, the ♠K is not a King, it is a Key-Card which you have already counted. So you bid 6♦. Partner counts 13 tricks and bids 7NT.

Board 20

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 9 6 5 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ K Q J 2

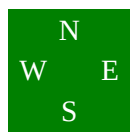
♣ —

♠ 10

♥ 10 7 5 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A Q 10 7 6



♠ Q J 7 3

♥ A 8

♦ 10 8 6 4

♣ K J 5

♠ 8 2

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 8 4 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ 3

Partner's 3♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points and good ♠ support.

What you DO NOT say next is 4NT. If partner answered 1 Key-Card you would not know what to do. If he has a red Ace you can make slam, but if his one Key-Card were the ♣A you couldn't. Instead you make a control-showing bid of 4♣, promising first round control. Partner obliges you by bidding 4♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bidding is like the Sherlock Holmes tale Silver Blaze, about the dog that didn't bark. Partner's ♥ bid shows that he **DOES** have the ♥A, but equally important it shows that he **DOES NOT** have the ♦A. So you know you don't have a ♥ loser but do have a ♦ loser. You bid 6♠.